



free will
and
determinism

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "against compatibilist free will" is written in white, bold, lowercase letters, arranged in three lines.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the reality of free will.

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

A compatibility believer in free will rejects premise (1). An incompatibilist believer in free will rejects premise (2).

This is the consequence argument.

Now that we have a grip on determinism and on one view of free will which would arguably be compatible with determinism, let's look at the central argument against the view that free will is compatible with determinism.

One way to present this argument starts with two very plausible premises.

No one has any choice about the
state of the world in the
distant past.

No one has any choice
about what the laws of
nature are.

Last time, we talked about the idea that we might now have a choice about some past facts — for example, you might have a choice now about whether the belief your roommate formed yesterday about what you would do today was true.

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

reality of free will.



The master argument against the reality of free will

believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

deterrinism.

central argument against the view that free will is compatible with

Now that we have a grip on determinism and on one view of free will

which arguably be compatible with determinism, let's look at the

One way to present this argument starts with every plausible premise.





distasteful.

started the world in the

None has any choice about the



None has any choice

about what the laws of

in vivo and in vitro.

Last time, we talked about the idea that we might now have a

yesterday about what you would do today was true.

choice about some past facts — for example, you might have a

choice now about whether the belief you're forming

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

for (2), and one for (3).





happened in the distant past.

2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

future is not as it was with the state of the

4. If determinism is true, the laws of

1. No one has any choice about events which

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

then DECISION happens. (3)

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

choice about DECISION (2,6,7)

theorie about the fact that if DNR

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

3. If determined, the only one

of interest.

varlatatie + the last of the last.



5. No one has any choice about what the laws

about whether @.

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

and none has any choice about whether,

then DECISION. (4,5)

choice about the laws of nature, then no

combination of four - that No

This argument seems to show that the

choice principle, and determinism

rules out free will.

one has any choice about the past, no

seems to show that if determinism is

dearminism.

seem quite plausible, the argument

hence that free will is incompatible with

true, there are no free actions — and

Since the first three of these theses



Real/|the master argument:

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

against
compatibilist
free will

A large red circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is arranged in three lines, centered within the circle.

**against
incompatibilist
free will**

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will



No one has any choice about the
state of the world in the
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